Eight steps from a contract arriving to signed or rejected. Place one dot on the single most cumbersome step.

DOT VOTE

	INPUT: a contract or draft arrives	Step 1. Intake and logging	Step 2. Triage and prioritisation	Step 3. Assemble context before reading	Step 4. Read the draft against the playbook	Step 5. Cross check against what AtliQ already signed	Step 6. Decide the route: sign, redline or escalate	Step 7. Negotiate	Step 8. Sign, file and move on	OUTPUT: signed or rejected
Actions by Human		1. Sellers or Karandeep receive drafts by email 2. Forwarded to Karandeep, sometimes logged 3. Saved to a drive, laptop, or left in email	1. Scans the queue, usually only when chased 2. Sellers chase him directly for their own deals 3. Decides the review order in his head	1. Works out which entity signs and which law applies 2. Tries to recall what AtliQ already promised 3. Searches email and drives for the past contract 4. Works out which companion documents are needed 5. Asks the CTO what can be reused 6. Tries to recall past negotiation positions	1. Reads the draft end to end, usually after 10pm 2. Checks parties and governing law against the entity 3. Checks penalties, liability, indemnity, IP, payment 4. For an NDA, checks it is genuinely mutual 5. For AtliQ paper, checks it is not unfair 6. Marks what to push back on	1. Compares against remembered non competes 2. Checks whether rates undercut a pricing promise 3. Checks whether IP was already assigned elsewhere 4. Checks the document bundle is complete 5. Checks where client data is allowed to sit	1. Decides sign as is, redline, or send to counsel 2. Briefs counsel, agrees a fee and a turnaround 3. Weighs the deadline against the risk 4. Sometimes approves a deliberate one off exception	1. Writes redlines or a position email 2. Exchanges versions with the counterparty 3. Concedes, holds, or walks away 4. Reads the revised draft again each round	1. Karandeep signs, the only signatory for both entities 2. Sends the executed copy back 3. Saves it somewhere 4. Updates the tracker, sometimes	
Actions by Digital Tools and Platforms in use		1. Email, the real inbox for contracts 2. contract_tracker.csv, updated by hand 3. Shared drive, personal laptops, email attachments	1. A list on a whiteboard 2. Email search 3. The tracker, with stale statuses	1. Email search, the main retrieval tool 2. Entities fact sheet kept by finance 3. A review checklist in Keep from March 2024 4. A partial, unreviewed note of past negotiations	1. A PDF reader or Word, on a laptop or a phone 2. The Google Keep checklist	NONE. No tool exists for this step. Fallback is memory and email search. What is missing: a register of everything AtliQ has already committed to.	1. Email and phone calls 2. Two outside law firms, one in India and one in the US	1. Word with tracked changes 2. Email threads	1. Email and e signature 2. Drive folders and personal laptops	
Associated Pain Points		1. Contracts live in four places 2. Many rows have no file location 3. Signing entity and status often blank 4. One duplicate row for the same SOW 5. Deadlines sit in free text, not a date field 6. Restrictive clauses column almost always empty	1. No owner, no agreed order, no deadline per contract 2. One reviewer for 7 to 9 documents a month 3. A contract waits one week to one month in the queue 4. Urgency only visible when someone shouts	1. No register of commitments exists 2. One past contract took 20 minutes to find 3. Nobody knew if a restriction had expired 4. The checklist is two years old and one sided 5. Negotiation history lives in old email threads 6. Counsel cannot advise on one contract alone	1. Two hours per contract, several passes if complex 2. Read on a phone, one signed at an airport gate 3. Routine and ruinous clauses read alike at 11pm 4. No formal checklist exists, only his experience 5. One rushed signature cost a quarter of that deal 6. Buried traps: daily penalties, unlimited liability	1. This step has no tooling at all 2. The biggest collision was caught by accident 3. An India only pilot includes Gulf properties 4. A sharper rate triggers a retroactive credit 5. A tool signed away to one client, warranted to another 6. Insurance required is five times the cover held	1. Counsel runs about $5,000 a year, 5 to 7 working days 2. Best case lands a day before the deadline 3. Counsel needs a list of commitments nobody has 4. The engagement letter sat unsigned while time ran 5. Exceptions look identical to mistakes on paper 6. Deadline pressure pushes everything to sign now	1. Positions rebuilt from memory every round 2. One markup held over a month with no movement 3. Every round costs another late night reread 4. Wins never flow back into AtliQ own template 5. No record of what was conceded, or why	1. Executed contracts scatter across inboxes and laptops 2. Tracker statuses go stale after signing 3. Restrictive clauses are never recorded 4. A consent letter could not be found afterwards 5. No obligations register, so step 3 restarts at zero	

VOTE: Step 5. It is the only column whose tools row is empty, so collisions are caught by accident rather than by process. Fixing step 5 also removes most of step 3 pain, because both are starved by the same missing artifact: a register of what AtliQ has already committed to. Voted solo on 7 Oct 2026, then VALIDATED by the client on 7 and 8 Oct.

KARANDEEP, 8 Oct: We should be avoiding breaking any clauses generally which we have with our clients. If one of our contracts restricts us from working with the hotel industry in Dubai, and we are signing another contract for the same, IT SHOULD FLAG IT TO US.

KARANDEEP, 8 Oct: There's no checklist generally, but IT SHOULD BE A WIN WIN. Another example would be, if an NDA is one sided, I wouldn't prefer signing it.

KARANDEEP, 8 Oct: If there's a healthcare project, I WOULD WANT TO SIGN BAA FIRST THING, with my freelancers as well.

Voted step: Step 5, recall what we have already promised. Redesigned below.

33A cards we took

- AI finds all relevant information
- AI finds one specific piece of information
- AI organizes notes into a structured record
- AI shows the connection between different data
- AI summarizes text
- Understanding the past and the present
- REJECTED: AI recommends actions and plans
- JOKER: not AI at all. Plain arithmetic.

What that actually means here

- Sweep 12 signed contracts for every promise made
- Pull only the clauses that could touch this draft
- Register holds quote, file, clause, both dates
- Match Al Noor GCC clause to a Saudi hotel deal
- One page brief, not a contract summary
- Derive the 1x fees pattern from our own history
- Refused. It reports, Karandeep decides.
- Dates and proportionality are rules, not a model

What we carry into the PRD

AI builds the two records AtliQ has never had: a cited commitments register carrying both the contract end date and the obligation end date, and a negotiating pattern derived from its own signed contracts. On each draft it retrieves what could collide, tests whether a waiver actually covers this engagement, and returns a severity ordered brief with every clause quoted.

Two of the five checks use no model at all. Entity against governing law is a lookup. Proportionality against contract value is arithmetic. We reached for the cheapest technique that works, and only used AI where nothing cheaper does.

New actions by the human

- Read the three line verdict header
- Read findings in consequence order
- Decide: sign, redline, or escalate
- Record an accepted exception with a reason
- Nominate a reviewer when travelling
- Sign. Never delegated, never automated.

New pain points the AI introduces

- A fabricated clause or citation
- A live collision is missed
- Tail mis-dated, clears a live restriction
- Waiver read too broadly, clears a breach
- False alarms pile up, he stops reading
- Over trust. He stops reading the contract.

Guardrails. Each one is a commitment.

- Quote verified verbatim, or the finding is dropped
- Never says safe to sign. No write actions.
- 100% recall on seeded collisions to launch
- Lapsed restrictions shown, never hidden
- A disclaimer on anything uncertain
- PHI never sent. Mask before any API call.